

10-Week Project Timeline: Hangman Game (Java Swing)

Week	Task Name	Description & Key Implementations
Week 1	Project Setup & Basic Structure	Create the project in NetBeans and design the basic framework using the HangmanGame class as the main window.
Week 2	Reading Words from File	Code the loadWords() method to open words.txt, read the hidden words and hints using Scanner, and split them.
Week 3	Game Logic & 3 Lives Limit	Write the core matching logic inside guess() to track player inputs, update correct characters, and handle the 3-lives limit.
Week 4	Designing the Window Layout	Arrange the visual components (JFrame, JPanel, labels, text fields, and buttons) using standard Swing layouts.
Week 5	Drawing the Stickman	Create the HangmanPanel class and use paintComponent with Graphics2D to draw the gallows and the 3-stage stickman.
Week 6	Adding Timer & Input Handling	Implement javax.swing.Timer for the 60-second countdown and set up ActionListener for buttons and enter-key inputs.
Week 7	Tracking Guessed Letters	Integrate a HashSet named used to save already typed characters and block duplicate inputs automatically.
Week 8	Adding Sound Effects	Code the playSound() method using AudioInputStream and Clip to trigger correct, wrong, and gameover wav files.
Week 9	Testing & Fixing Bugs	Test the entire game for edge-cases, check how the UI behaves during timeouts, and handle potential file-missing errors.
Week 10	Final Check & Submission	Run a final check on the code, ensure the red/green on-screen win/lose status works perfectly, and prepare for the presentation.